

Some Hot Picks Among Budget Laptops

Brand	Model number	Screen size	Processor	RAM	HDD	OS	Battery life (as claimed by the company)	Price
Acer	Aspire AS5750z	39.6 cm (15.6 inches)	Intel Pentium Dual Core (2nd Generation)	4GB DDR3 (expandable up to 8 GB)	500 GB	Linux	Up to 4.5 hours	Rs 24,327
Asus	X54C-SX261D	39.6 cm (15.6 inches)	Intel Core i3 (2nd Generation)	2GB DDR3 (expandable up to 4 GB)	500 GB	Free DOS	Up to 3 hours	Rs 24,850
HP	Mini 210 210-4020TU	25.7 cm (10.1 inches)	Intel Atom Dual Core (2nd Generation)	2GB DDR3	320 GB	Windows 7 Starter	Up to 3 hours	Rs 21,152
Samsung	NP300E5Z-A0N	39.6 cm (15.6 inches)	Intel Pentium Dual Core (2nd Generation)	2GB DDR3	320 GB	Free DOS	Up to 3 hours	Rs 22,152
Toshiba	Satellite C Series C640-I4017	35.6 cm (14 inches)	Intel Core i3 (2nd Generation)	2GB DDR3 (expandable up to 8 GB)	320 GB	No OS	Up to 3 hours	Rs 23,850

operating system (OS) running in laptops across homes and offices, it is advisable to opt for a minimum of 3GB RAM.

Moving forward, under the Rs 25,000 price point, you can get a maximum of 4GB DDR3. On the other hand, 2GB RAM is what you find in a majority of low-end and mid-end laptops in the market, which is adequate for carrying out above-average fundamental operations. Before buying a laptop, it is advisable to check whether its RAM can be upgraded. This will give you an upper-hand in case you feel the need for some extra memory.

Hard disk capacity

Regardless of the screen size or processor type, typ-

ically you would find majority of the laptops having 320 GB of hard disk space. The said capacity is adequate, given you have moderate file-download and music/video needs. But if you are determined to give your laptop a 'music and video library touch' and enjoy seeing an envious look on the face of ogglers, you can get a few choices in 500GB capacity without surpassing your budget.

Additionally, you always have the option of adding those extra gigs

of storage space via an external hard drive but that too comes at a price!

Optical drives

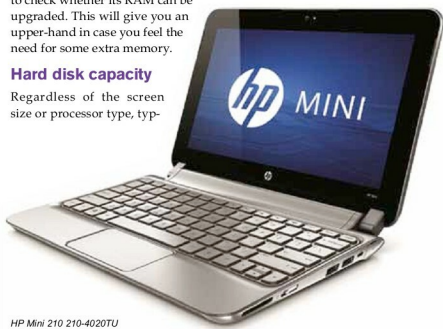
When you buy an easy-on-pocket netbook, the first thing you should not expect is an optical drive. On the other hand, almost all standard-screen-size laptops come with a DVD drive capable of reading and writing data.

Though the use of USB drives for accessing multimedia, software and other data is rapidly rising, it is good to have an optical drive in your laptop that can be useful while creating CDs/DVDs for those older generation of video players and car entertainment systems.

Battery life

This is one aspect that needs definite attention. With an aim to drive their sales in the market, companies claim their laptops to have six hours, eight hours and even up to ten hours of battery life.

A laptop promising up to eight hours of battery life is sure to tilt your buying decision in its favour. But if you go down the memory lane and find it really hard to remember the last time when you actually took your existing laptop out for a ride,



HP Mini 210 210-4020TU